MMT, Journalism and a post-truth world

In 2016 YouGov asked the UK public if they felt “politicians and the media talk about economics in a way that is accessible and easy to understand”.

Only 12% answered yes.

7% C2DE

15% ABC1

Economics dominates the political sphere

- most policies justified in terms of it
- economic growth dominates discussion



Before 1950 'the economy' was not mentioned in the p

By 2017

Conservatives mentioned it 74 times
Labour mentioned it 56 times
Lib Dems mentioned it 52 times

2010: first American-style TV debates.

2015: Four live TV debates between David Camer



Economics dominates the political sphere, but econon

- **neo-liberal in micro** – deregulation, privatisation
- **austerity for macro** – government expenditure to be

Enabled even after the crash because politicians repe


ΑΣΤΥΝΟΜΙΑ
POLICE
ΑΣΤΥΝΟΜΙΑ
POLICE

The Economist

Fake news flourishes when partisan audiences crave it

Demand for lies and misinformation encourages media organisations to provide them

Jean-Claude Trichet, chair of the ECB, —‘the idea that a

June 2010

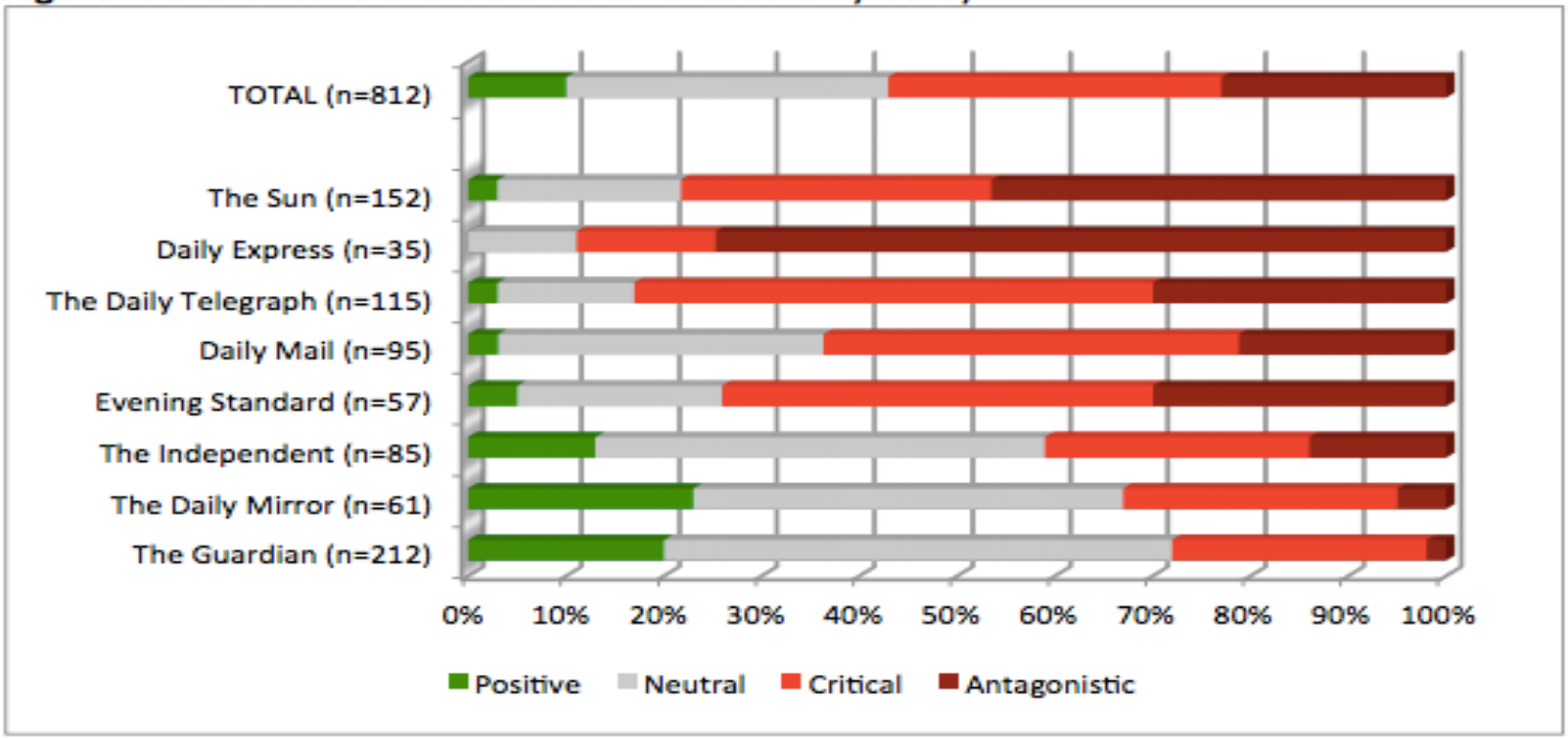
Figure 3: Lenin and Corbyn in *The Sun*, 30 November 2015



Comrade Jeremy . . . in cap like Russian revolutionary Lenin at rally

The" antagonistic" tone" refers" to" the" delegitimisation" of
disingenuous,"insulting"or"mocking.

Figure 1: Overall tone of the article towards Jeremy Corbyn



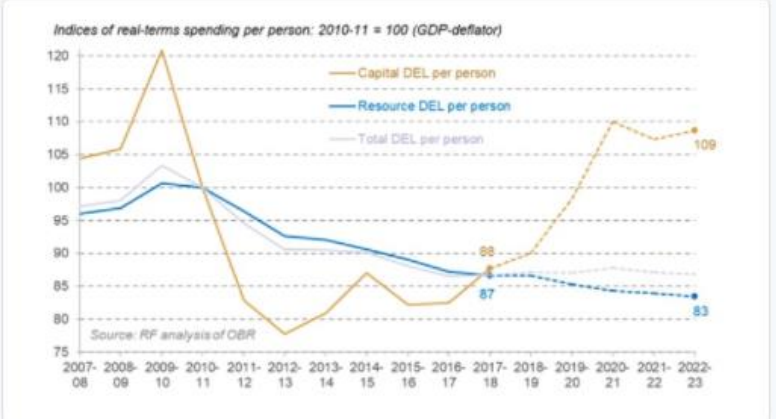
Is there any wonder we have a credibility crisis, when we squander it daily?

PR or journalism?headlines a day after



Twitter within minutes of speech

Focusing instead on resource spending (**RDEL**) – what we use to pay teachers' and nurses' salaries, run prisons and libraries – real spending per person is on course to fall further in the coming years. Austerity, says @TorstenBell, ain't over yet.



'Why did no one see it coming?'

- Queen Elizabeth II

At the LSE

Oct 2008

Notes

INTRODUCTION

1. Norman Tebbit's advice in 1981; he repeated it in 2011.
2. The Queen's question might have been more accurately posed as 'Why did no one in mainstream economics see it coming?' What follows is about the views of the economists 'in power'. To a number of economists outside the mainstream, such as William Black, Stephen Keen, Randall Wray and James Galbraith, it was obvious that the financial system was on an unsustainable roll. Of those in the mainstream, Raghuram Rajan and Robert Shiller can claim credit for having foreseen a crisis, for various reasons. The general cause of the financial collapse had been previsioned by Hyman Minsky in his 'financial instability hypothesis', see Minsky (1992).
3. Quoted in Kynaston (2017), p. 358. Montagu Norman to Henry Clay.
4. The original is a bit more verbose than the familiar form given above. Ronald Reagan's actual words were: 'In this present crisis, government is not the solution to our problem; government is the problem.' (See Reagan (1981).)
5. Hicks (1976), pp. 208–9.
6. Keynes (1936), pp. 383–4.
7. Dasgupta (1985), pp. 1–2.
8. Marx and Engels (1962), p. 53

The game of policy making is rigged; the theory used c

(men and women in power who believe themselves ab



Journalism let this happen.

- failed to interrogate its own failures
- failed to be curious
- failed to give equal weight to those voices outside of

Public trust in UK media has reached all time lows

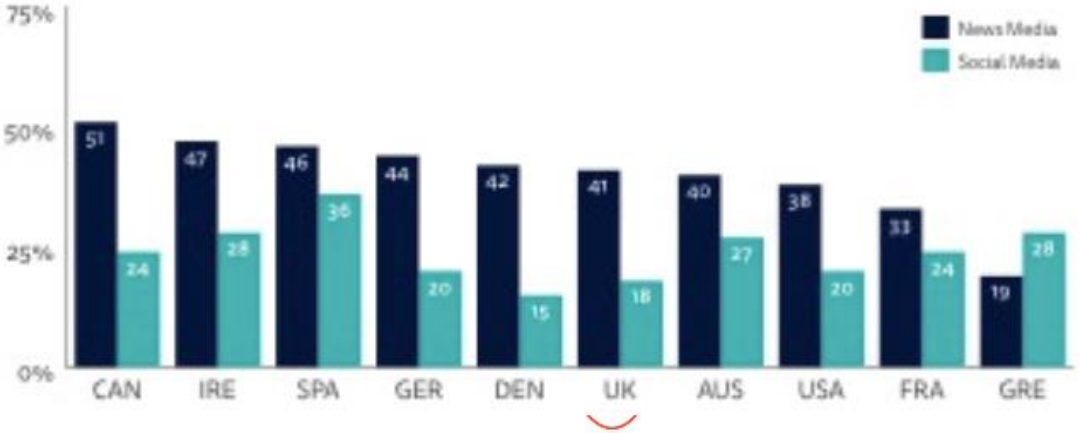
“In 2017 at 24%, trust has
only been lower in the aftermath of the
phone hacking scandal of 2011…
the proportion of people saying they
regard familiar news organisations as
reliable and trustworthy fell in 1 year from 55% to 48%

Just 2 in 5 respondents to Reuters News report agree that the media does a good job in helping separate fact from fiction

TRUST IN THE NEWS BY POLITICAL ALLEGIANCE – UK AND US



PROPORTION THAT AGREE THE NEWS MEDIA/SOCIAL MEDIA DOES A GOOD JOB IN HELPING SEPARATE FACT FROM FICTION – SELECTED COUNTRIES



Guardian.com performs strongly behind BBC, Sky News & ITV – *Google News figures very high...*

	BBC website/app	Sky News website/app	Daily Mail website/app	Guardian/ Observer	YouTube	Google News	MSN News	Yahoo News	Huffington Post	ITV/ITN* website/app	Telegraph website/app	Independent website/app
	989	*290*	*286*	*253*	*224*	*187*	*180*	*175*	*170*	*154*	*117*	*113*
Is important to me personally	77%	74%	56%	68%	62%	76%	60%	54%	50%	63%	47%	59%
Is high quality	81%	80%	51%	74%	53%	65%	50%	44%	47%	67%	64%	64%
Is accurate	78%	74%	52%	68%	43%	61%	50%	43%	50%	70%	59%	69%
Is trustworthy	76%	73%	48%	72%	41%	60%	49%	46%	48%	66%	55%	59%
Is impartial	68%	74%	40%	52%	44%	61%	49%	42%	49%	62%	46%	54%
Offers a range of opinions	69%	74%	48%	60%	67%	66%	50%	48%	54%	66%	57%	60%
Helps me make up my mind	66%	68%	47%	63%	50%	59%	44%	37%	43%	63%	53%	58%
Helps me understand what's going on in the world today	80%	82%	58%	76%	56%	74%	53%	51%	58%	67%	62%	68%
Has a depth of analysis and content not available elsewhere	66%	75%	47%	73%	57%	59%	45%	35%	50%	65%	63%	62%

The Guardian

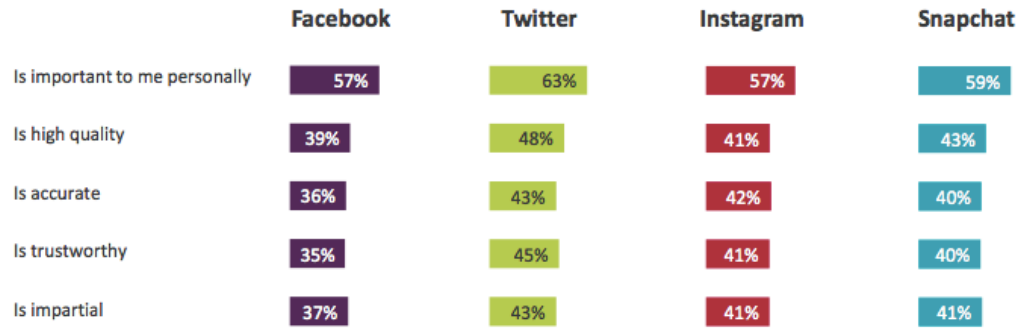
Online is now the primary source of news for 61% of p
Social media is the primary source for a third of people

Facebook 3rd most popular

	2018
BBC One	62%
ITV/ITV WALES/UTV/STV	41%
Facebook	33%
BBC News Channel	26%
Sky News Channel	24%
BBC website/app	23%
Channel 4	18%
Google (search engine)	17%
Twitter	14%
BBC Two	14%

fter the

Social media gets high scores on personal importance + diversity of opinions – *Facebook ranks lowest for trust/accuracy*



What is to be done?

1/ Change the story

The government has become a tool of big busine

make it possible for eve

MMT is a very useful way of framing the economy and

It allows you to think differently, to change the frame



The Guardian view on a job guarantee: a policy whose time has come

Editorial

Ministers need to adopt measures that secure a basic human right to engage in productive employment



The Guardian view on record employment: Not the whole picture

Editorial

Economic insecurity means that real unemployment is double that which is officially recorded. A new institutional framework to deliver and maintain full employment is needed



The Guardian view on the NHS cash boost: pay for it with deficit spending

Editorial

The public knows that the health service needs more money. Theresa May's offer is a start – but unlikely to be enough

Recognise that inequality is a real and growing p
People and groups have different opportunities i
Stress the importance of manufacturing within th
See the trade deficit, don't see the City as the be
There is a place for common ownership of goods
See the government as responsible for managin

MMT: Part of a tradition

Michal Kalecki, John Maynard Key  , Lorie Ta



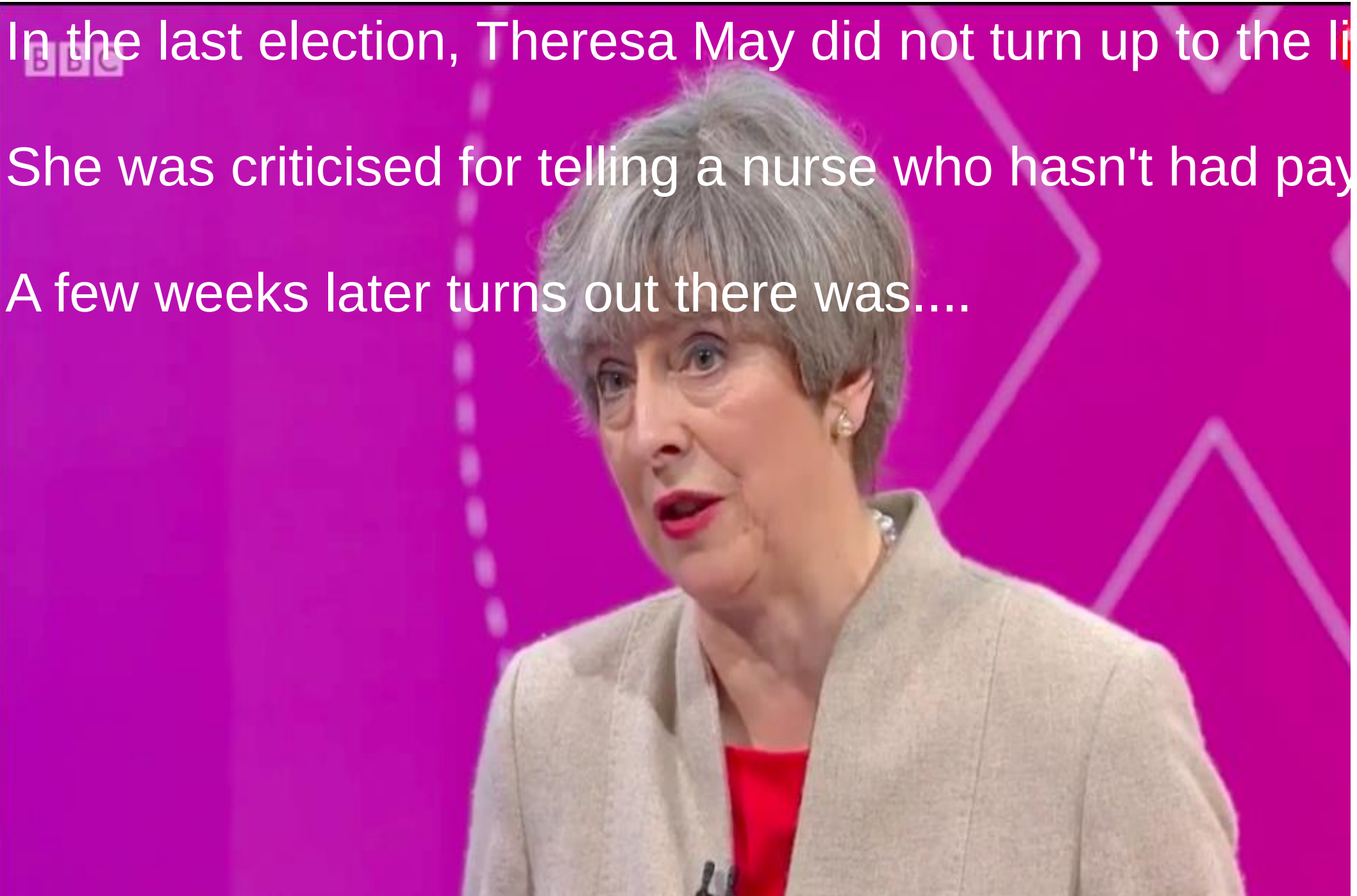


Radical

Where a government issues its own currency i



There's a chance to “rewrite the underlying rules” of po


In the last election, Theresa May did not turn up to the li
She was criticised for telling a nurse who hasn't had pay
A few weeks later turns out there was....